

Chapter 62 - Gift

The next day was the annual New Year's Day holiday, and the Feng family was unusually all at home resting together.

Feng Yue didn't have the habit of sleeping in, and since she had to get up every morning to take medicine, her daily routine was very regular.

Father Feng and Mother Feng were middle-aged health enthusiasts who consistently went to bed early and woke up early, so this was a rare occasion for their family to sit together for breakfast after a long time.

Aunt Zhao had prepared Chinese breakfast items that the family was accustomed to: two bamboo steamers of freshly made vegetarian xiaolongbao¹, a pot of fragrant and rich seafood porridge, and two plates of pickled vegetables that Aunt Zhao had made herself.

The family sat around the dining table. Father Feng habitually picked up the morning newspaper to read, while Mother Feng was chatting with someone on her phone, typing rapidly with one hand.

The youngest at the table, Feng Yue, had nothing to do and was quietly eating her breakfast.

Following routine, Aunt Zhao brought Father Feng's daily morning strong tea to the table, then brought something she had discovered in the courtyard that morning into the dining room.

"Madam, the gardener Xiao Chen found this bag at the front gate while cleaning the courtyard this morning."

Hearing this, the family all looked toward the bag. Feng Yue recognized the familiar bag and had a mouthful of xiaolongbao that she could neither swallow nor spit out.

Mother Feng put down her phone, looking puzzled. "I haven't bought anything. This shouldn't be mine. What's inside? Did you look?"

Aunt Zhao nodded. "The bag seems to contain some kind of gift, wrapped nicely in packaging."

"Since we don't know whose it is, let's check the surveillance outside later. If it was left by a stranger, we'll just throw it away," Father Feng said.

"No need." Hearing about checking surveillance, Feng Yue quickly spoke up to stop Aunt Zhao.

"This is my stuff. I forgot to bring it in last night and just left it outside."

Mother Feng raised her eyebrows slightly, curious and gossipy. "Nuan Nuan, who gave this to you?"

Feng Yue nodded with a complicated expression.

"Who gave it?"

Feng Yue answered evasively, "A... a friend..."

"Oh, then your friend is quite thoughtful, giving you a New Year's gift." Mother Feng didn't pursue who this person was, but looked curiously at the bag. "Since it's a gift for you, aren't you going to open it and look?"

"Ah... mm, I'll look now." Feng Yue reluctantly took the bag from Aunt Zhao and took out the gift inside.

She had no idea when Yan Lin had placed this thing in their courtyard, and now her mother had seen it too. She hoped it wasn't something inappropriate.

The gift was wrapped in a layer of cream-colored wrapping paper printed with pale dandelions. A somewhat rough pale yellow ribbon bow was stuck on top of the box, with two curled ribbons hanging down on either side of the wrapping paper.

"Which store wrapped this? The craftsmanship doesn't look very good."

Feng Yue silently agreed. The wrapping paper covering the box was obviously wrinkled on the surface, the tape joints were crooked, and that pale yellow bow - she could even see the maker's clumsiness.

The gifts Yan Lin had chosen in the past never had these detail problems. She wondered which packaging store had wrapped this one.

Feng Yue unwrapped the paper, finally revealing what was inside.

A red and white plastic canopy with four small wheels underneath.

A miniature street food cart appeared before Feng Yue.

Feng Yue took the item out, and only now did she notice that on the front of the small cart was a tiny sign.

The sign had only three characters "Liu Cun Yue²" with a crescent moon beside it.

The two parents naturally saw this sign, but they still weren't clear what this thing was.

"What is this? A toy?" Mother Feng asked.

Looking at the small cart, Feng Yue was somewhat dazed. Hearing her mother's question, she came back to her senses and said, "It's not a toy, it's a cotton candy machine."

"Cotton candy machine?" Mother Feng found this somewhat familiar. After thinking, she suddenly understood. "I remember now - you mentioned this briefly in one of your videos!"

Mother Feng was also a loyal fan of Feng Yue and naturally watched every video.

"This is a nice gift. Your friend wouldn't happen to be one of your fans, would they?"

Feng Yue sat there somewhat stunned, even the porridge in front of her had gone cold. Her mother was right - she had indeed mentioned in a video that she had seen a very cute cotton candy machine online and might do a review of it for everyone if she had the chance.

But she hadn't expected Yan Lin to have watched that video, and even less expected Yan Lin to give her this cotton candy machine as a New Year's gift.

Thinking carefully, the gifts Yan Lin had given her in the past had never been priced under ten thousand yuan - roses, custom-made shoes, auction jewelry, cosmetics, and even that one-of-a-kind cultivated rose variety. Each and every item was valuable.

But this small cotton candy machine probably cost less than five hundred yuan.

Yet this was the first time Feng Yue couldn't ignore a gift worth less than five hundred yuan.

"I remember you said before that you wanted to review this cotton candy machine. Now it's perfect - you have a ready-made one."

Faced with her mother's words, Feng Yue couldn't say a word. She just nodded randomly and stuffed the thing back in the box.

Father Feng noticed something was wrong with his child and spoke up to change the topic. "Never mind about gifts. Let's eat breakfast first - the porridge is getting cold."

Mother Feng nodded. "Right, right, Nuan Nuan, hurry up and drink some more or the seafood porridge will develop a fishy taste when it gets cold."

The dining table returned to its usual calm.

After finishing breakfast, Mother Feng, who had been looking at her phone throughout the meal, suddenly exclaimed.

"What's wrong?" Father Feng inquired.

"Mrs. Zhou told me that the Wang family's child was taken away by police last night!"

Hearing this, Feng Yue was stunned. This Wang family child - could it be Wang Huili?

"Mom, is it Wang Huili?"

Mother Feng nodded. "Yes, yes, that's her. I forgot her name for a moment. Your Aunt Zhou said last night the Wang family was in complete chaos, and even Old Wang went along."

Feng Yue hadn't expected the police to act so quickly, but thinking about it, it made sense. The kidnapped person was Qian He, and Qian He's father Qian Yaozhu was no pushover.

However, what Feng Yue didn't expect was that the police's swift action in taking Wang Huili away wasn't actually the Qian family's doing.

When Feng Yue was being taken to the police station for questioning, Yan Lin had already gone to see the police chief.

She hadn't said much, merely expressing her earnest hope that the police could handle this matter quickly.

Whether it was the Qian family or the Yan family, both were prominent families in Beijing. Combined with kidnapping being a very serious criminal case, Wang Huili was swiftly taken to the station.

On New Year's Day morning, while Feng Yue was at home having breakfast with her parents, Yan Lin had gotten up early and rushed to the police station with her people.

When she saw Wang Huili, it had been almost nine hours since Wang Huili was detained.

Wang Huili wore a fluffy nightgown with an ill-fitting black down jacket over it. Her disheveled hair and prominent dark circles under her eyes made her look particularly haggard, completely lacking her usual glamorous appearance.

When Wang Huili saw Yan Lin, she instinctively lowered her head, as if unwilling to let the other person see her in this state.

The two faced each other across iron bars. Yan Lin had Mo Yixu, who was working overtime during the holiday, behind her. Yan Lin took a file folder from him and signaled for him to wait outside.

Once Mo Yixu left, only Wang Huili and Yan Lin remained.

Wang Huili stubbornly refused to speak, so Yan Lin had to take the initiative. "I remember I warned you before. Does Miss Wang think I forgot?"

Hearing this, Wang Huili suddenly looked up, her eyes like poisoned daggers glaring viciously at Yan Lin.

"I don't know what you're talking about."

"Don't know what I'm talking about? Don't worry, you'll know."

Yan Lin sneered and took a step forward. The aura of someone who had long held high positions pressed down on Wang Huili like a mountain, making it hard for her to breathe.

Not only that, Wang Huili also sensed an extremely dangerous signal from Yan Lin. Her sixth sense told her that if she touched the other person's sore spot one more time, endless pain and torment would await her.

She would die.

This thought suddenly appeared in Wang Huili's mind. The fear of having her life threatened swept through her entire body. She kept backing up several steps until her back touched the wall of the detention cell.

"What do you want to do! This is a police station!" Wang Huili roared like a madwoman. Combined with her current appearance, she really did look like a mentally unstable crazy woman.

Yan Lin lowered her eyes and slightly curved her lips. "Miss Wang, you're joking. What can I do? I'm just here to provide some clues to the police."

With that, Yan Lin opened the file folder and took out a stack of papers. "These contain your money transfer records with those people, call records, and chat records of you threatening other victims."

"Of course, there are also surveillance videos of each of your meetings." A small USB drive appeared in Yan Lin's hand.

"I don't know what you're talking about! My family's lawyer will prove my innocence! All of this is forged!"

Hearing this, Yan Lin wasn't angry. She just slowly stuffed those things back into the file folder.

"It seems Miss Wang has truly forgotten how I warned you in the restaurant last time."

"I will hold 'you people' accountable for all the harm Feng Yue suffered." Yan Lin stared fixedly at Wang Huili locked in the detention cell. "Miss Wang probably didn't understand what 'you people' refers to."

"No matter, you'll know soon." Yan Lin finished speaking and turned directly around. "Oh right, I forgot to tell you - your family's lawyer probably doesn't have the energy to handle this small matter of yours for now."

After saying this, Yan Lin no longer paid attention to Wang Huili's impotent rage behind her. Her expression returned to that cold and murderous look.

Yan Lin handed all the evidence she had found to the police, then left the station with Mo Yixu.

They still had more important things to do today.

Yan Lin had always been someone who meant what she said. Unfortunately, Wang Huili clearly hadn't understood this principle.

After driving for some time, the vehicle stopped below an office building.

Yan Lin looked at the tall building standing before her, her expression cold. After a while, she seemed to think of something, and the coldness on her face gradually softened.

This unplanned gift - she hoped Ah Yue would like it.

Mo Yixu stood behind Yan Lin, looking at this brand-new office building, couldn't help but sigh inwardly.

Some people's business empires built over half a lifetime could turn to dust overnight.

How sad and pitiful.

Footnotes:

¹ Xiaolongbao (小笼包) - Traditional Chinese steamed soup dumplings, typically small and filled with meat or vegetables

² Liu Cun Yue (六寸月) - This is Feng Yue's online username, literally meaning "Six-inch Moon"